User Research Summary

Survey: 13 students | Interviews: 2 first-year students | November 2026

1. Research Purpose and Method

The research explored whether students have unused items, how they currently pass them on, second-hand purchasing behaviour, trust and safety preferences, and interest in a combined buy/sell/donate platform. Primary research consisted of an anonymous Google Forms survey and two short interviews with first-year students.

Survey sample	13 students; question-level response counts ranged from 11 to 13.
Year of study	10 first-year (76.9%); 2 second-year (15.4%); 1 fourth-year (7.7%).
Residence	8 day scholars (61.5%); 2 PG/rented (15.4%); 1 hostel resident (7.7%); 2 other/unlabelled responses.
Interviews	2 first-year students. Qualitative context only; not representative of all students.

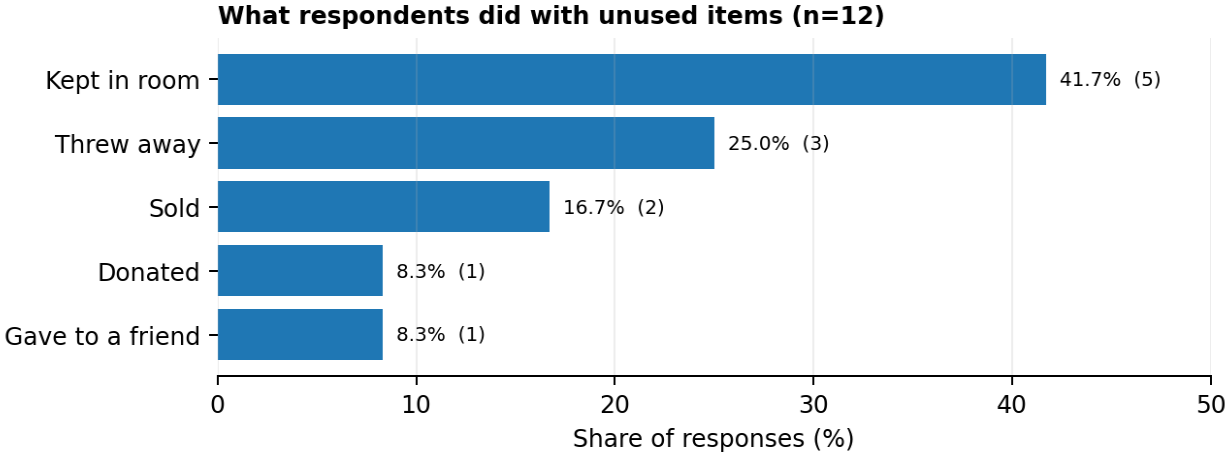
2. Quantitative Survey Findings

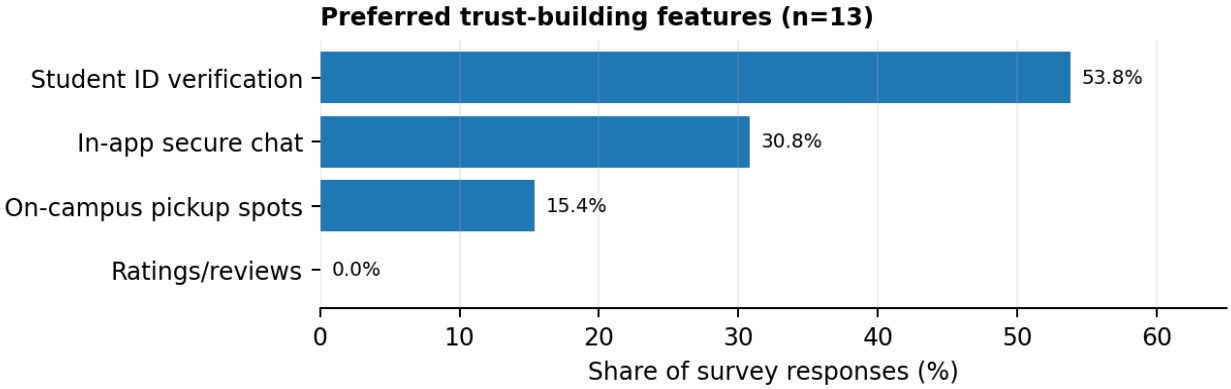
The percentages below use the response count for each question, not automatically the full survey sample.

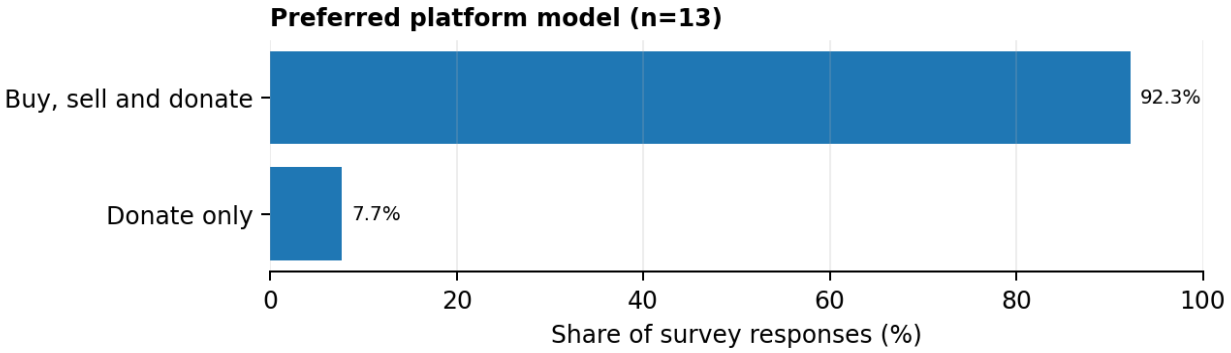
Question / measure	Result	Interpretation
Bought a used item in the past year (n=13)	3 yes (23.1%); 10 no (76.9%).	Prior second-hand purchasing was uncommon in this small sample.
Unused items reported (n=11)	6 selected textbooks/study materials (54.5%).	Academic materials are a useful initial category to test.
Actions for unused items (n=12)	5 kept in room (41.7%); 3 threw away (25%); 2 sold (16.7%); 1 donated (8.3%); 1 gave to a friend (8.3%).	8 of 12 (66.7%) kept or discarded items.
Trust features (n=13)	7 ID verification (53.8%); 4 in-app secure chat (30.8%); 2 pickup spots (15.4%); 0 ratings/reviews.	Make student verification visible; chat can be considered after the core MVP.
Preferred exchange model (n=13)	12 preferred buy, sell and donate (92.3%); 1 selected donate only (7.7%).	A combined exchange model with a clear donation option is supported by this sample.

3. Survey Results at a Glance

The charts below restate the response counts and percentages visible in the survey/report materials.







4. Interview Themes

Both interviewees were first-year students. They described challenges around affordable academic materials and a preference for a student-only, campus-based exchange environment.

Theme	What both interviews indicated	Product implication
Affordability and books	Finding second-hand academic books in good condition at reasonable prices was difficult.	Prioritize books and study materials as a category to test.
Trust and verification	Both preferred a student-only environment and considered college ID or institutional email verification important.	Make verification visible and define a workable campus check.
Listing transparency	Students wanted clear pictures, descriptions and information about item condition.	Require clear photos and item-condition details.
Campus convenience	Participants preferred exchanging items with other students on campus.	Keep the initial marketplace campus-specific.
Discovery and passing on items	They wanted simple categories and a convenient way to sell, exchange or donate unused items.	Use categories, search, filters and a visible free/donate option.

5. Product Implications

For the MVP: verified student sign-up; listings with photos and condition; search and filters; item details; seller contact; donation/free option; sold/given status; and basic reporting. Later: in-app chat, favorites and meetup suggestions are V2; impact tracking and seller ratings are V3.

6. Limitations and Interpretation

The survey was small (n=13), non-random and weighted toward first-year students and day scholars. Individual questions had 11–13 responses. Only one respondent identified as a college-hostel resident. The two interviews provide qualitative context but cannot establish how common a need is across the full campus. Findings are directional, not representative. The clickable prototype has not been usability-tested, and the concept has not been launched.

Source note: Survey counts and percentages are taken from the uploaded report and Google Forms chart screenshots. Interview themes are summarized from the two-student interview summary. No unsupported respondent-level claims or invented quotations are added.

Prototype reference: Open CampusLoop clickable Figma prototype